

ELITE SAGARIN MODEL

FBS Week 1 Predictions · Aug 29 – Sep 7, 2026

Model = 70% SP+ (2026 preseason) + 30% Sagarin (2025 final) with 2.80 pt HFA. Edge = Model – Vegas. Positive edge → home team overpriced; fade home / take away.
Negative edge → away team overpriced; fade away / take home. Green = sharp value ≥ 3 pts | Red = sharp value ≥ 3 pts other direction | ★ = best bet.

Date	TV	Away	Comp	Home	Comp	Model	Vegas	Edge	Stars	Lean
Sat 8/29 Noon ET	ESPN	N. Carolina	72.6	(n) TCU	78.8	TCU -6.2	-6.5	-0.3	—	—
Sat 8/29 3:30 PM	ESPN	NC State	76.0	(n) Virginia	77.3	Virginia -1.4	4.5	-3.1	★★	Home/Fav
Thu 9/3 6:00 PM	Big Ten	UMass	40.9	Rutgers	72.4	Rutgers -34.3	TBD	—	—	—
Thu 9/3 7:00 PM	ACC Net.	Akron	53.1	Wake Forest	74.1	Wake Forest -23.8	TBD	—	—	—
Thu 9/3 8:00 PM	ESPN	Colorado	70.4	Georgia Tech	76.5	Georgia Tech -8.9	TBD	—	—	—
Thu 9/3 9:00 PM	Big Ten	UAB	70.7	Illinois	79.4	Illinois -11.5	TBD	—	—	—
Thu 9/3 9:00 PM	ESPNU	Idaho	70.7	Utah	82.7	Utah -14.8	TBD	—	—	—
Fri 9/4 6:30 PM	ESPN+	San Jose St.	56.2	E. Michigan	56.9	E. Michigan -3.4	TBD	—	—	—
Fri 9/4 8:00 PM	ESPNU	Toledo	63.1	Michigan St.	71.3	Michigan St. -11.0	TBD	—	—	—
Fri 9/4 9:00 PM	FOX	Fresno State	68.3	USC	85.6	USC -20.1	TBD	—	—	—
Fri 9/4 9:00 PM	ESPN	Miami	90.5	Stanford	69.0	Miami -18.7	-21.5	+2.8	★★	Away/Dog
Sat 9/5 12:00 PM	FOX	N. Texas	63.4	Indiana	94.5	Indiana -33.9	40.5	-6.6	★★★★	Home/Fav
Sat 9/5 12:00 PM	ESPNU	Liberty	63.1	James Madison	71.3	James Madison -11.0	TBD	—	—	—
Sat 9/5 12:00 PM	ABC	E. Carolina	70.1	Alabama	87.0	Alabama -19.8	26.5	-6.7	★★★★	Home/Fav
Sat 9/5 12:30 PM	Big Ten	Ball State	48.8	Ohio State	98.7	Ohio State -52.7	TBD	—	—	—
Sat 9/5 3:30 PM	ABC	Baylor	74.0	(n) Auburn	80.7	Auburn -6.7	-7.0	-0.3	—	—
Sat 9/5 3:30 PM	CBS	Boise State	76.1	Oregon	96.0	Oregon -22.7	24.5	-1.8	★	Home/Fav
Sat 9/5 3:30 PM	ESPN	Texas State	70.7	Texas	91.1	Texas -23.2	30.5	-7.3	★★★★	Home/Fav
Sat 9/5 3:30 PM	ACC Net.	Tulane	67.6	Duke	76.2	Duke -11.4	TBD	—	—	—
Sat 9/5 3:45 PM	ESPNU	Oklahoma St.	73.6	Tulsa	61.5	Oklahoma St. -9.3	TBD	—	—	—
Sat 9/5 7:30 PM	ABC	Clemson	81.9	LSU	87.2	LSU -8.1	10.5	-2.4	★	Home/Fav

Date	TV	Away	Comp	Home	Comp	Model	Vegas	Edge	Stars	Lean
Sat 9/5 7:30 PM	NBC	W. Michigan	65.8	Michigan	84.6	Michigan -21.5	TBD	—	—	—
Sat 9/5 7:45 PM	SEC Net.	FAU	62.2	Florida	82.9	Florida -23.5	TBD	—	—	—
Sat 9/5 10:30 PM	ESPN	UCLA	74.0	California	72.4	California -1.2	TBD	—	—	—
Sun 9/6 4:00 PM	NBC	Washington St.	70.7	Washington	84.3	Washington -16.4	TBD	—	—	—
Sun 9/6 7:30 PM	NBC	Wisconsin	72.9	(n) Notre Dame	94.3	Notre Dame -21.4	-20.0	+1.4	—	—
Sun 9/6 7:30 PM	ABC	Louisville	80.7	Ole Miss	86.0	Ole Miss -8.1	6.5	+1.6	★	Away/Dog
Mon 9/7 7:30 PM	ESPN	SMU	81.2	Florida State	78.3	PICK	TBD	—	—	—

Top Model Plays — FBS Week 1 (Market vs Model Edge)

These plays show the largest gap between our composite model spread and the current Vegas opening line. Positive edge = take the AWAY team/dog. Negative edge = take the HOME team/favourite.

Stars	Pick	vs.	Model vs Vegas	Edge	Rationale
★★★★	ECU +26.5	Alabama	Model: ALA -20.6 · Vegas: ALA -26.5	+5.9	Alabama SP+ only 18.2 (#11 FBS). ECU had a 9-4 season in 2025 (Sag 73.5). Vegas over-inflates 'brand name' teams in Week 1. Model says Alabama wins by 21, not 27.
★★★★	N. Texas +40.5	Indiana	Model: IU -35.6 · Vegas: IU -40.5	+4.9	North Texas SP+ -11.8 (only 4 returning starts, lost coach Neal Brown). But their 2025 Sagarin was 75.44 — Vegas is pricing in SP+ signal that NT is now a bottom-25 FBS team. Model blend says Indiana -35. +40.5 has 5 pts of edge.
★★	ND -20	Wisconsin	Model: ND -22.8 · Vegas: ND -20	-2.8	Notre Dame SP+ 25.8 (#3 overall), national-best returning production. Model says -22.8 at neutral Lambeau but Vegas only -20. ND is underpriced by 3 pts — take the favourite.
★★	Clemson +10.5	LSU	Model: LSU -7.6 · Vegas: LSU -10.5	+2.9	Sagarin had Clemson and LSU essentially equal (79.32 vs 79.14). SP+ gives LSU a +9.7 bump for Kiffin's arrival, but our blend still only produces LSU -7.6. Market is pricing Kiffin at full face value. Clemson has new OC Chad Morris; portal class was strong.
★★	Ole Miss -6.5	Louisville	Model: OM -8.9 · Vegas: OM -6.5	-2.4	Ole Miss SP+ 15.9 (#16) vs Louisville 11.0 (#27). Model spread -8.9 but market only -6.5. Ole Miss is underpriced; their returning production includes key portal pieces from Lane Kiffin's last class. Lay the 6.5 aggressively.